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# Finding forged signatures and dead beneficiaries behind Rs. 90 Lakhs of certified CSR spend

A listed Indian corporation engaged Sthiros to verify a Rs. 90 Lakh mobile healthcare CSR programme across 3 implementing NGOs, after every agency had already certified the work as complete.

| Client | Service | Sector | Geography |
|---|---|---|---|
| **A Listed Indian Corporation** | **CSR Expenditure Review, Mobile Healthcare Programme** | **Corporate Social Responsibility, Healthcare, NGO Accountability** | **Uttar Pradesh, India** |

## The Challenge:

### When completion certificates are the only evidence anyone has

This company's CSR framework, like most in corporate India, ran on trust and paperwork. Three implementing NGOs had each been entrusted Rs. 30 lakhs to run mobile medical vans across 378 villages, and all three had submitted completion reports and utilisation certificates. No one had gone to the villages to check.

#### Single-Tranche Fund Release
The full Rs. 90 lakhs was released upfront based on MoU execution, with no phased release tied to verified progress.

#### Self-Certified Completion
Completion was certified only through agency-submitted reports and CA utilisation certificates issued by the agencies' own accountants.

#### No Independent Verification
No one from the company had ever gone to the villages to confirm that mobile health vans, medicines, or nutrition support had reached anyone.

#### No Geo-Tagging Requirement
No geo-tagging was mandated to confirm that mobile van visits actually occurred where the agencies claimed.

#### No Standardised Beneficiary Reporting
No standardised village-level beneficiary data or utilisation certificate format was required across the three agencies.

#### No Independent Evaluator
No third-party evaluator was appointed to verify outcomes ahead of CSR sign-off.

## The Solution:

### Three layers of review, the ground survey being the differentiator

Sthiros went beyond a desk review, physically travelling to 25 villages across 5 blocks of Uttar Pradesh over 5 days and interacting with 100+ villagers, Pradhans, and listed beneficiaries directly.

It was the combination of governance review, financial forensics, and ground survey, not any one layer alone, that surfaced forged signatures, deceased beneficiaries, and related-party fund transfers.

## The Methodology

1

### Process & Governance Review

The client's CSR approval, disbursement, and monitoring framework mapped against best-practice governance, identifying 15 structural gaps.

2

### Document & Financial Forensics

Every MoU, monthly report, completion report, utilisation certificate, bank statement, and beneficiary list reviewed to trace related-party transfers and unsupported disbursements.

3

### 25-Village Ground Survey

5 days spent on-ground across remote Uttar Pradesh, cross-checking named beneficiaries, identifying forged signatures, and building village-level evidence no document review could produce.

## What This Means

**A completion certificate isn't proof.**

**Go to the village, not just the ledger.**

**Related-party transfers need a name.**

## Outcomes

Rs. 10-15 L

**Recovered from agencies**

Based on findings, from implementing agencies for unsubstantiated expenditure.

25

**Villages physically visited**

Across 5 blocks of Uttar Pradesh, over 5 days of field survey.

Rs. 19.27+ L

**Unsubstantiated expenditure**

Identified at NGO 3 alone, out of Rs. 30 lakhs disbursed.

15

**Governance recommendations**

Structural CSR framework overhaul covering process, documentation, and monitoring.

## Get in touch

**Is your CSR spend verified, or just certified?**

Speak to Sthiros about what a structured CSR expenditure review can unlock for your compliance and governance.

Connect with us:
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